

F1.18 Textiles and the making called women's work; women's making beyond textiles

Institutions put women at the loom and the kiln, and credit lines then decided whose hands the record kept.

Spec

Row	Content
Essential question	Who decided that this making was "women's work", and whose names did the record keep?
Opening move	Making first, before any text. The learner twists a two-ply cord from a strip of paper or yarn for two minutes, guided by a 40-second film of our own hands (no words on screen). Then three open cloths appear with the question "Who made this: a woman, a man, or both?" A kente cloth (Met 85576, Asante), a Diné wearing blanket (Cleveland 1921.556, "woman artist") and an Inca tunic (Cleveland 1957.136). Claim: "Weaving has always been women's work." Counter-claim: who wove depended on place and on who was made to. "Most kente weavers are men" (Smarthistory). Inca fine tapestry was made by women and men (Met essay; Cleveland record). Ur III weavers were mostly women, but one tablet names male weavers (Garcia-Ventura 2014). Opening case: the kente cloth, because it breaks the claim at once.

Row	Content
Lab	Every hand. A credit ledger laid over one object. The learner drags role cards (designed, spun, dyed, wove or stitched, shaped, polished, painted, fired, supervised, sold, named on the label) onto the AIC <i>Lotus</i> curtain (1918.298), then onto the Cleveland plate signed "Marie and Santana" (1951.363, link out). Each card must carry a name, "unnamed" or "not known". The ledger then shows the holder's own label beside the learner's, so the gaps are visible.
Concept	About 700 words. Three mechanisms. Assignment: institutions placed women at looms: the Ur III state workshops (rations), the Inca aqllawasi (tribute), Lowell's mills (wages), the Bauhaus "women's workshop" (a school's policy), the Dhaka garment floor. Erasure: credit moved to a father (Honeysuckle, 1890), a firm (Morris & Co.), a trader (INS013) or a teacher (Cardew and Kwali). Naming: women put their own names on the work: "Marie + Julian", "Marie and Santana", Kwali's name on the Abuja pottery from the early 1980s, Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay's boards and emporia. Beyond textiles: Tewa pottery, Gbari pottery (Ladi Kwali), Anangu and NPY fibre sculpture (Tjanpi, link out). It closes on the difference between rations, wages and a signature, and says what the record cannot tell us: how most of these women saw their work.

Row	Content
Cases	Three object stories. 1. Oil for 4,272 women (F1.9a). A Girsu account (HSS 04, 003) that, as Waetzoldt read it, lists 4,272 women and 1,800 children from Guabba in the weaving sector. Shown with the Met's open Ur III labour record 57.16.1 and a diagram of our own; the Harvard tablet is link-out only. 2. Honeysuckle, 1883 (F1.11). May Morris's wallpaper, credited to her father in 1890 and first given to her in a catalogue of about 1909. It is paired with her <i>Lotus</i> design, embroidered in Chicago in 1888 by the Decorative Arts Society (AIC 1918.298, open). 3. "Marie and Santana" (F1.7, non-textile). A San Ildefonso (P'ohwhóge Owingeh) blackware plate, c. 1943–51, signed with two names (Cleveland 1951.363, link out). The signature history runs from unsigned to "Marie", then "Marie + Julian", then "Marie + Santana". Notice required.
Apply — maker	Credit line. Write the full credit line for a textile or object you made, own or are wearing. Name every hand: design, fibre or clay, spinning, dyeing, weaving or shaping, finishing, factory or workshop, seller, name on the label. Write "not known" where you cannot find a hand; never leave it out. Add one confidence word per line.
Apply — briefer	Credit clause. For a textile or craft object you would commission, write the credit clause of the brief. It names which hands the supplier must disclose (designer, maker or factory, finisher, where the fibre or clay comes from), how each will be credited on the label and in marketing, and what "handmade" must mean. The fashion system (couture houses, the department store) is taken in F1.21: link, do not repeat.

Row	Content
Partner	Historian. Agenda: records keep the names of those who ordered, paid or signed. Question: "Whose name is on it, who put it there, and when?" Test: the learner names one hand the record leaves out (the 1,800 children, the Chicago embroiderers, Santana), gives the evidence that the hand existed, and writes one sentence with a confidence word.
Forms	3 (object story), 7 (video)
Consumption forms	Five-minute: twist the cord, sort the three cloths, read the Honeysuckle credit change. Session: opening, lab, concept, three cases, Apply, Historian test. Reference: the credit-line template, the signature timeline, the claims sheet.
Media	A 40-second film of our own hands twisting cord (captioned; no voice needed). A 1965 film, <i>Pottery Techniques of Maria [Martinez] of San Ildefonso</i> (Internet Archive; link out, rights not stated). Open images: AIC, Cleveland, Met. Our own drawings: a ration-list layout (labelled as a diagram, not a copy of the tablet) and the blackware process steps. Our own map.
Artifact fields	Practice depth. SRC: one full credit line with confidence words. GRM.m: the material and hand processes named in it (fibre, spin, dye, coil, burnish, smother-fire, embroider).
Threads	Attribution and Authority (main): signature, firm, father and state as credit-holders. Writing and Argument: the credit line as a short argument. Accessibility (level 1): alt text that describes structure (weave, stitch, surface), not only motif; captions and a text description for both films. Planetary Weight: light touch only, where the cotton at Lowell and in Dhaka came from (link to F1.22).

Row	Content
Closing contribution	SRC line: "[Object]: designed by ...; made by ...; finished by ...; named on the label: ...; not known: ... (confidence)."
Claims sheet	20 claims below; one interpretive (the unit's framing).

1. Responsibility block

This unit must reach:

- **Groupings and makers:** INS092 Ur III state textile workshops; MKR023 Aqllakuna; MKR031 Lowell mill workers and PLC125; EVT032 Rana Plaza (OCC275 as neighbour); MKR076 Morris & Co. with PER418, PER419, PER420; INS057 Bauhaus with PER431 Anni Albers, PER432 Gunta Stölzl, PER433 Otti Berger; PER108 Maria Martinez, PER109 Julian Martinez, STY077, COM100; PER032 Ladi Kwali and PER033 Michael Cardew; PER248 Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay with INS034 and MOV086; MKR003 and PRA002 kente; PRA035 Diné weaving (register PR-013); PRA208 and MKR087 Aboriginal fibre work (link out).
- **Object types:** OBT032 tunic, OBT044 strip-woven cloth, OBT073 olla, OBT123 clay tablet; wallpaper and embroidered hanging (no OBT row; see Nodes).
- **Techniques and materials:** TEC083 drop spindle, TEC092 tapestry, TEC099 narrow strip, TEC112 embroidery, TEC019 coil building, TEC024 burnishing; MAT058 wool, MAT064 camelid fibre.
- **Periods:** Ur III (c. 2112–2004 BCE), Late Horizon (HOR003, 1438–1533), 1830s–40s Lowell, 1880s–1900s London and Chicago, 1919–33 Bauhaus, 1918–1980 San Ildefonso, 1952–80s Abuja, 2013 Dhaka.

World chapters reached (six): F1.9a (case 1, plus INS093 as contrast); F1.11 (case 2, plus the Bauhaus); F1.7 (case 3, plus aqllakuna, Diné weaving and Lowell); F1.6 (kente in the opening; Ladi Kwali); F1.9 (Rana Plaza; Kamaladevi); F1.12 (Tjanpi, link out only).

Carried by the Atlas or other units instead: Al Sadu (PRA131, MKR058) stays in the regional slot; a link only. The fashion system (GAP072 haute couture, GAP073 department store) belongs to F1.21. Lamassī and the Kanesh letters (PER283, INS093, TXT042) go to F1.13, with a one-line link here. Diné weaving history (CL-171, CL-172, WS-054) is taught in F1.7; here it is one opening object. Hosteen Klah's sandpainting textiles (PER112) are excluded (sacred). The Arts and Crafts grouping page carries the rest of the Morris story.

2. Protocol screen

- **Human remains:** none shown. The Inca capacocha is not taught here; aqllakuna appear only as weavers and brewers.
- **Possible grave goods:** Cleveland 1957.136 (Inca tunic) has no findspot. Content note: "Many Andean textiles in museums came from burials; where this one was found is not recorded."
- **Indigenous material, Notice on each:** San Ildefonso Pueblo (case 3, the 1965 film); Diné (WS-054); Asante (kente); Anangu and NPY women (Tjanpi, link out; PRA208 says some designs and forms are restricted, so no images unless Tjanpi publishes and permits them).
- **Sacred:** no avanyu or ceremonial pieces are chosen for case 3; the feather-design plate is used instead.
- **People never as goods:** the Ur III tablet lists women and children in an oil account. Write "women and children listed as ration recipients", never "units" or "stock". For aqllakuna, "chosen women" is the Inca and Spanish term; put it in quotation marks and attribute it.
- **Content notes:** Ur III (children's labour); aqllakuna (girls taken from families); Rana Plaza (mass death; no images of the dead or the rubble with people); Otti Berger (murdered at Auschwitz, 1944).

3. Claims

1. HSS IV 3, as Waetzoldt (1972) read it, lists 4,272 women and 1,800 children from Guabba in the weaving sector. *Documented* (secondary). Vermaak 2008, <https://www.harappa.com/content/guabba-meluhhan-village-mesopotamia>. Depth: full text of the article; Waetzoldt not opened.
2. CDLI catalogues HSS 04, 003 (P110276) as an Ur III account from Girsu: "large balanced account; sesame oil and lard", Harvard SM 1899.02.001, photo © Harvard. *Documented*. <https://cdli.earth/artifacts/110276>. Depth: full record. How the weaver count sits in the account: not verified.
3. Most Ur III weavers were women, but not all: UET 3, 1449 says "the male workers are weavers". *Documented*. Garcia-Ventura 2014, https://www.academia.edu/8710629/Weaving_in_Ur_III_Mesopotamia_Womens_Work. Depth: summary.
4. Women workers in Ur III usually received half the rations of men. *Probable*. Same source. Depth: summary.

5. Ur III labour came mostly from dependent people who owed service to the crown; slaves were a limited part, working beside people of other statuses. *Probable* (for the weavers specifically: not stated). Reid 2023, <https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/international-review-of-social-history/article/punishment-for-the-coercion-of-labour-during-the-ur-iii-period/63F85846BCF0661180D19F3ECE24864F>. Depth: abstract and introduction.
6. Inca officials collected girls aged eight to ten from the provinces "as tribute for the state"; they trained about four years in spinning, weaving, food and chicha in the aqllawasi. *Documented* in Spanish-era sources as summarised. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Aclla>. Depth: summary; the chronicles were not opened.
7. Whether selection was coercion or a route to status: *contested*. Reading one: girls were taken as tribute and later assigned as wives or to temples (Wikipedia, Accla). Reading two: the women held rank and made the empire's most valued cloth (Cleveland 1957.136 text). The women's own view is not known.
8. Fine Inca tapestry "was made ... by women of noble families, by professional weavers, and by the Accla (Chosen Women)"; the Met says "a select group of female and male weavers". *Documented*. <https://clevelandart.org/art/1957.136>; <https://www.metmuseum.org/essays/andean-textiles> (McHugh 2020). Depth: full record; full essay.
9. "Most kente weavers are men." *Documented*. Micots, <https://smarthistory.org/kente-cloth/>. Depth: full text.
10. May Morris designed *Honeysuckle* (1883). An 1890 *Woman's World* article credited it to William Morris. A Morris & Co. catalogue of about 1909 first gave it to May, and a letter of hers confirms it. *Documented*; the gallery notes that some still argue her father was chief designer (*contested*: give both readings). <https://wmgallery.org.uk/object/honeysuckle-wallpaper/>. Depth: full record.
11. The *Lotus* door curtain: design May Morris; producer Morris & Co.; embroidered by the Decorative Arts Society, Chicago, 1888, for Frances Glessner's parlour. *Documented*. <https://api.artic.edu/api/v1/artworks/74514>. Depth: full record.
12. At the Bauhaus, weaving became known as the "women's workshop". Anni Albers went into it "unenthusiastically, as merely the least objectionable choice". *Documented*. <https://www.tate.org.uk/whats-on/tate-modern/anni-albers/exhibition-guide>. Depth: full text (the quotation's original source not opened).
13. Gunta Stölzl became a junior master in 1927 and ran the weaving workshop. Mies van der Rohe required her resignation in 1931 amid Nazi pressure, and swastikas were painted on her door. *Documented*. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gunta_St%C3%B6lzl.

Depth: summary.

14. Maria Martinez (Po've'ka) coiled and polished; Julian Martinez painted; Hewett asked her to remake pottery from excavated sherds. *Documented*. Turnbow 2025, <https://womenshistory.si.edu/blog/fragments-ancient-pottery-inspired-maria-martinez>. Depth: full text.
15. Signatures ran: unsigned (1918–23), "Marie" (1923–25), "Marie + Julian" (1925–43), "Marie + Santana" (1943–54), "Maria/Popovi" (from 1956). *Probable* (dates differ by source). https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Maria_Martinez. Depth: summary.
16. Cleveland 1951.363, c. 1943–51, is "Signed: Marie and Santana"; the record credits both women as artists. *Documented*. <https://clevelandart.org/art/1951.363>. Depth: full record.
17. Ladi Kwali learned coiling from her aunt, joined Cardew's Abuja pottery in 1954 as its first woman potter, and received an MBE in 1963. The pottery was renamed for her in the early 1980s. *Documented*. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ladi_Kwali. Depth: summary.
18. Lowell's workers were "young Yankee women, generally 15–30"; most worked 12 to 14 hours a day, and women struck twice in the 1830s. *Documented*. <https://www.nps.gov/lowe/learn/historyculture/the-mill-girls-of-lowell.htm>. Depth: full page.
19. Over 1,100 people, mostly garment workers, died at Rana Plaza on 24 April 2013. The typical Bangladeshi garment worker is "female, 23 years old, and an internal migrant". *Documented*. ILO, <https://webapps.ilo.org/infostories/en-GB/Stories/Country-Focus/rana-plaza.html>. Depth: full page.
20. **The unit's framing:** "women's work" is a category that states, schools, firms and markets produced and enforced, not a fact about women. *Interpretive*.

Supporting, not counted: Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay was the first chair of the All India Handicrafts Board and set up Cottage Industries emporia (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kamaladevi_Chattopadhyay; the 1952 date is from canon, not confirmed on that page). Tjanpi "represents over 400 artists from 26 communities" (<https://tjanpi.com.au/>).

4. Nodes

Case or claim	Canon IDs
Opening	PRA002, MKR003, TEC099, OBT044, COM030; PRA035, TEC131, COM097; CIV022, POL061, MKR023, MAT064, TEC092
Case 1	INS092, OBT123, MAT058, TEC083; neighbour INS093, PER283, TXT042
Case 2	PER420, PER418, PER419, MKR076, MOV005, TEC112; INS057, PER431, PER432, PER433
Case 3	PER108, PER109, COM100, STY077, TEC019, TEC024; PER032, PER033
Claims 18–19	MKR031, PLC125; EVT032, OCC275
Concept	PER248, INS034, MOV086; PRA208, MKR087, COM258; GAP072, GAP073 (links)

Proposed new rows: Santana Roybal Martinez (person, F1.7; 1909–2002, per Cleveland). Popovi Da (person, F1.7). Decorative Arts Society, Chicago (maker-community, F1.7; founded 1877 per AIC). Guabba (place, F1.9a). Women's Guild of Arts (institution, F1.11; 1907). Abuja Pottery Training Centre, later Ladi Kwali Pottery (institution, F1.6). Wallpaper (object type). Cumbi/qompi cloth (object type, F1.7).

5. Candidate open objects

#	Holder, accession	Object	Date range (holder's words)	Licence as stated	1970 status	Record
1	AIC 1918.298	Lotus door curtain; design May Morris, Morris & Co.; embroidered by the Decorative Arts Society, Chicago	design by 1888, made 1888	Public domain	n/a (decorative); Glessner gift 1918	https://www.artic.edu/artworks/74514
2	Cleveland 1957.136	Tunic, Inca; tapestry, cotton and camelid fibre	c. 1400–1540	CC0	Pass: in the museum by 1957 (John Wise; gift of William R. Carlisle); findspot not recorded	https://clevelandart.org/art/1957.136

#	Holder, accession	Object	Date range (holder's words)	Licence as stated	1970 status	Record
3	Met 85576 (1972.56.1)	Kente Prestige Cloth, Asante; cotton, silk	19th century	Public domain (isPublicDomain: true)	n/a (not archaeological); purchased 1972	https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/85576
4	Cleveland 1921.556	Wearing blanket, Diné, "woman artist"; handspun, Germantown and bayeta wool	c. 1875–80	CC0	n/a; gift of J. H. Wade, 1921	https://clevelandart.org/art/1921.556
5	Met 324586 (57.16.1)	Cuneiform tablet with seal: record of labourers for irrigation work, Umma	ca. 2042 BCE	Public domain (isPublicDomain: true)	Pass: gift of Mrs Henry E. Coe, 1957	https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/324586

No open object exists for the Guabba tablet (© Harvard), *Honeysuckle* (© William Morris Gallery), any Maria Martinez pot (Cleveland's 11 records all "Copyrighted"), Ladi Kwali, Stölzl or Albers. Use link-outs and drawings of our own. Object 5 stands in for how the Ur III state counted workers; it is not a weaving record.

6. People and credit

Named: May Morris, William Morris, Frances Glessner; Maria Martinez (Po've'ka), Julian Martinez, Santana Roybal Martinez, Popovi Da, and Clara and Adam (in the 1965 film); Ladi Kwali and Michael Cardew; Gunta Stölzl, Anni Albers, Otti Berger; Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay. **Left out by the credit:** the Chicago embroiderers (only the society is named); the Morris & Co. embroiderers; the 4,272 women and 1,800 children, named in no source we opened; the Asante spinners and traders behind kente (MKR003 "leaves out"); the Diné weaver of 1921.556; the Gbari women potters who taught Kwali; the unnamed Rana Plaza dead, named in union and ILO records we have not opened. Credit runs both ways in case 3: Julian's name joined the signature in 1925, and Santana's in 1943.

7. Visual plan (zero cost)

- **Form 3, case 1:** Met 324586 (open image); our own diagram of a ration-list layout, labelled as a diagram; CDLI link out for HSS 04, 003; our own map of Girsu and Guabba.
- **Form 3, case 2:** AIC 1918.298 (open image); William Morris Gallery *Honeysuckle* (link out); a timeline of our own, 1883–1890–c. 1909.
- **Form 3, case 3:** Cleveland 1951.363 (link out); our own drawing of the process steps (coil, scrape, slip, polish, paint in slip, smother-fire); a signature timeline set in type, not traced from pots.

- **Opening:** our own film of hands; open images of Met 85576, Cleveland 1921.556 and 1957.136.
- **Form 7:** our own 40-second film; the 1965 Internet Archive film as a link out (rights not stated; no embed until cleared).
- **Concept:** Tjanpi, the Bauhaus, Kwali, Lowell and Rana Plaza are link-outs only; our own map of all places.
- No generated images of any object, person or place.

8. Success criteria

1. The learner's credit line names at least four roles for one object and marks each unknown hand "not known" instead of dropping it.
2. For one case, the learner states which institution assigned the making, and quotes the record that shows it.
3. The learner rewrites one label (museum, shop or their own) to add a missing hand, with a confidence word.

9. Readings and risks

The Historian pre-read (pack v2) should check: Waetzoldt 1972 (the numbers reach us through Vermaak and a secondary article); Garcia-Ventura 2014 on male weavers; Reid 2023 on status (only the abstract was read); a primary or scholarly source on the aqllakuna beyond Wikipedia; the William Morris Gallery and AIC texts on *Honeysuckle*; a San Ildefonso or Tewa-authored source on the signatures.

Hold until a reader clears them:

- The aqllakuna step (framing and wording of "tribute").
- Rana Plaza (content note, number of dead; sources say 1,134, 1,138 or "over 1,100").
- Case 3 and the 1965 film (Notice wording). The Internet Archive description calls Maria "90-year-old" in 1965, when she was about 78; do not repeat it.
- The canon report that Maria signed other potters' pots (PER108 note). We found it only on dealer sites; not verified, so it is not taught.
- The Tjanpi link (restricted designs).

10. Fact-check list

- **R1 and R2 canon rows used:** R1: INS057, PLC125, PRA002, PRA035, PRA131, PER248, MOV005, MOV086, COM097, OBT044, OBT123, POL061. R2: INS092, MKR023, MKR031, MKR003, MKR076, PER032, PER108, PER418, PRA208, STY077, COM030, COM100, TEC019, TEC085, TEC092, TEC099, OBT032, GAP072, INS093.

- **Dates:** Stölzl 1927 and 1931; Kwali born c. 1925 (some say 1920); Kwali joined 1954; Abuja founded 1951 (canon) or April 1952 (Wikipedia); Kamaladevi chair 1952 (canon; not confirmed); *Honeysuckle* catalogue "about 1909"; Tjanpi start 1995 (canon; not verified).
- **Living people:** none named. Living communities: the San Ildefonso Martinez family potters, Tjanpi artists, Bonwire weavers, Diné weavers.
- **Endonyms:** P'ohwhóge Owingeh; Po've'ka; Diné; Gbari (Gwari); Asante (Asantefoo); Anangu and NPY; Tawantinsuyu; aqllakuna and aqllawasi (spelling differs: aclla, aklla).
- **UNESCO:** Al Sadu (2011 Urgent Safeguarding; 2025 transfer), mentioned as a link only; no other inscription is claimed.
- **Licences:** AIC 1918.298 public domain; Cleveland 1957.136 and 1921.556 CC0; Met 85576 and 324586 `isPublicDomain: true`. The 1965 film's rights are not stated. Cleveland 1951.363 is copyrighted, and the CDLI and William Morris Gallery images are ©.
- **Not verified:** the canon claim that Lowell's cotton was grown by enslaved people (not stated on the NPS page opened); what the Guabba women were paid in HSS 04, 003.